

GROUP DISCUSSION

(Reference)

How to start a Group Discussion?

Being given the role of initiator in a group discussion, you will surely get an edge over others since you have the chance to grab everybody's attention and make a great impression from the start. But starting a group discussion isn't as easy as it seems to be. It is beneficial to be the one to start a group discussion but it is also risky as it demands you to think on your feet and articulate an incredible starting line that can create an amazing impression. Here are the major steps you must follow if you are given the role of starting a group discussion:

- Introduce yourself first
- Be clear & coherent
- Present the topic with an interesting take
- Efficiently use your time
- Use quotes and questions to begin
- Understand the topic first
- Start with a famous but relevant quotation or phrase
- Lay down relevant statistics & figures
- Commence with an anecdote
- Start with a question and answer it yourself



How to interrupt or enter a GD when others are speaking?

Now that you are aware of how to start a Group Discussion, let us understand how you can enter a group discussion when others are speaking or interrupt in the middle. Here are the best tips to enter in the middle of a group discussion:

- Choose the right timing
- Be quick and concise
- Continue from the last speaker's views



How to conclude a Group Discussion?

Concluding a group discussion can seem as difficult as starting the GD. To summarize a group discussion, you have to stay alert throughout the whole discussion, keeping all the key pointers in mind as well as understanding the discourse. Here is how you can conclude a group discussion:

- Present a comprehensive summary
- Add relevant observation
- Include a closing argument



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Starting lines for a Group Discussion

While exploring the best ways to start a group discussion, gearing up for some starting lines will always help you prepare for this situation. Since many competitive exams are often succeeded by a group discussion, it is important to gear up for this aspect of the selection process of your chosen course or job profile. Here are some of the useful phrases-cum-initiation lines for group discussion that might come in handy if you are given the task to start a GD:

- “I would like to start by stating my view of the matter....”
- “I would like to put forward the point that....”
- You can start with a quote: “As X once had said...”
- If you are giving a definition related to the topic: “_____ is defined as.....”
- I am sure that some of you might agree with my point while others might not, but I would like to say that....”Hi everyone, I am _____ (name) and I would like to introduce the topic of this group discussion.
- Hello everyone, my name is _____ and I will be initiating the group discussion. I would like to ask a question from all of you. [Add a question here relevant to the topic]
- Mahatma Gandhi said, _____ [or any other relevant quote] and this corresponds to the topic of our group discussion today which is _____. I am _____ (name), the initiator of this group discussion and would like all of you to present your opinions on this topic. Good morning everyone, I am _____ and for today’s group discussion, we will be discoursing the topic of _____.Hi everyone, I am _____ and this group discussion will be focused on _____ First let me give you a brief overview of the topic